Day 52 - Upper Beaver Valley, Uplands Meadow, Boyne River Crossover, East Back Line, South Boardwalk

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Beaver Valley section · hike 63 · Upper Beaver Valley & Boyne River

6.4 km / 4.0 mi	~2.1 h	2.6 km new	110 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Limited roadside parking on the south side of East Back Line. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day52_hike063.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Upper Beaver Valley Side Trail (1.6 km); Uplands Meadow Side Trail (0.7 km); Boyne River Crossover Side Trail (0.2 km); East Back Line Side Trail (0.1 km); South Boardwalk Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Limited roadside parking on the south side of East Back Line.
- **Boyne River & main trail:** Forested trail that follows the Boyne River, crosses it, and runs up and down along the escarpment. A local club describes packed trail with lots of roots and many small-to-medium hills, plus one longer climb (easy to moderate). Poles are recommended.
- **Bridges and boardwalks:** Expect several bridges and many boardwalks, built in 2023 by Beaver Valley Bruce Trail volunteers. Boardwalks can be slippery when wet.

- **Ferns and views:** Look for maidenhair and hart's-tongue ferns. A trip report describes rugged terrain above the Boyne River with cascading waterfalls and a high meadow with views across to Cuckoo Valley and north down the Beaver Valley.
- **Upper Beaver Valley Side Trail:** Includes a road-shoulder section; keep Zappy close there. The Uplands Meadow Side Trail is part of the club's loop here.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Limited roadside parking on the south side of East Back Line. Walk about 40 m to the trail. Head north on the blue-blazed East Back Line Side Trail.
0.1	0.1	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
0.4	0.2	J2: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed South Boardwalk Side Trail goes off on your right.)
0.7	0.5	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Uplands Meadow Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.4	0.9	J4: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Upper Beaver Valley Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
3.6	2.2	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.5	2.8	J6: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.9	3.0	J7: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Boyne River Crossover Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.0	3.1	J8: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.2	3.2	J7: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
5.6	3.5	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the Uplands Meadow Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
5.9	3.7	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed South Boardwalk Side Trail, heading south. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
6.0	3.7	J9: End of the South Boardwalk Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
6.1	3.8	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
6.3	3.9	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed East Back Line Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
6.4	4.0	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Beaver Valley Probus Club hike listing and a Vanderplas family trip report.